

kids! I have customers who use Easy Daysies for their parents with Alzheimer's, and I'm working on a teen version, too."

There's no question that people want the product Elaine is selling, so much so that they personally reach out to thank her for the positive impact she has had on their lives. The good news is that Elaine is learning how to develop an expanded product line to service new markets with a much-needed product. That's entrepreneurship at its best.

### **Money Mistake:** *You Think "Family" Means Blood Relations*

#### **The Fix:** *Expand Your Definition*

Rob Dyer came onto the *Shark Tank* set wearing his military fatigues. He's an active-duty U.S. Marine Corps aviation officer, and the idea for his product, RuckPack, had first come to him during his second tour with MARSOC (Marine Corps Forces Special Operations Command). "I love the Marine Corps," he says. "I love being active duty, and I love serving my country. But I had bigger plans than to walk around being shot at my whole life."

Rob's "aha" moment came to him in Afghanistan, when he and his fellow Marines were deployed on missions that typically lasted a week or more. The only food they had was what they carried with them. That meant they were virtually all taking some sort of supplement or energy drink, and in Rob's words, "The energy drinks that are out right now suck." As snipers, they needed energy, but the caffeine in products like Red Bull gave them jittery fingers. They needed to recover quickly from dehydration and fatigue, but they also needed to be able to maintain extreme focus and mental acuity. It really was life or death.

At night, Rob and the other Marines would talk about what they wanted to do with their lives after the military; they had become brothers related by a common bond that went beyond blood, and they hoped to find a way to work together outside the military. They knew a lot about supplements, so they started talking about making a product that would provide the acuity and energy they so